Knowledge Representation and Reasoning
Project 4: Actions with Cost
Checkpoint 2

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Introduction

The field of Knowledge Representation and Reasoning (KRR) focuses on formalizing information so that a computer system can utilize it to solve complex tasks, such as simulating the evolution of a dynamic environment. Within this domain, action languages provide a structured way to model how autonomous agents interact with their surroundings through sequences of operations. By defining the logic behind state transitions, these systems enable automated reasoning about the consequences, feasibility, and resource requirements of specific plans. The primary objective of this project is to formalize and implement a logic-based framework for representing and reasoning about dynamic systems within the $\mathbb{DS}_4$ class. The class is an extension of class of dynamic systems described by Action Language $\mathbb{A}$, and has following assumptions:

1. **Inertia law:** Fluents persist in their state unless changed by an action.
2. **Complete information:** The system assumes full knowledge of all actions and all fluents.
3. **Branching model of time:** The temporal structure allows for multiple possible future paths.
4. **Deterministic and sequential actions:** Only one action occurs at a time, and every action has a single, predictable outcome.
5. **Characteristics of actions:**
   - *Precondition:* A set of literals representing the conditions for execution; if not met, the action results in an empty effect.
   - *Postcondition:* The specific effect of an action, represented as a literal.
   - *Cost:* A cost $\kappa \geq 1$ is required to perform an action. However, $\kappa = 0$ if the cost is unspecified or if the action results in an empty effect.
6. **Universal performance:** In every state, all actions are performed.
7. **Partial descriptions:** The system allows for incomplete descriptions of any given state.
8. **No constraints:** No state or domain constraints are admitted in this class.

The difference from standard Action Language $\mathbb{A}$ is the cost associated with an action.

1 Action language syntax

Here $\mathcal{A}c$ is the set of all actions and $\mathcal{F}$ is the set of all fluents.

1.1 Value statement

$$\bar{f} \text{ after } A_1, \ldots, A_n$$

Where $\bar{f} \in \mathcal{F}$ is a fluent and $A_1, \ldots, A_n \in \mathcal{A}c$ are actions.
Abbreviation when $n = 0$: initially $\bar{f}$

1.2 Effect statement

$$A \text{ causes } \bar{f} \text{ if } g_1, \ldots, g_k$$

Where $\bar{f}, g_1, \ldots, g_k \in \mathcal{F}$ are fluents and $A \in \mathcal{A}c$ is an action.
Abbreviation when $k = 0$: A_1 causes $\bar{f}$

1.3 Cost statement

$$A \text{ costs } \kappa$$

Where $A \in \mathcal{A}c$ is an action and $\kappa > 0$.

2 Action language semantics

A **signature** Υ consists of:

- A finite set of fluents $\mathcal{F}$
- A finite set of actions $\mathcal{A}c$

A non-empty set D of value/effect/cost statements is called an **action domain**. Let $D_{trans} \subseteq D$ be the set of all value and effect statements in D, and $D_{cost} \subseteq D$ be the set of all cost statements in D.

Model construction is based solely on D_{trans}. Cost statements D_{cost} play no role in determining whether a structure is a model; they are used only in a second phase, after the transition function Ψ has been fully determined, to label transitions with their costs.

A **transition function** is a mapping $\Psi : \mathcal{A}c \times \Sigma \to \Sigma$. The value $\Psi(A, \sigma)$ is the state resulting from performing action A in state σ. In case of the $\mathbb{DS}4$ class of dynamic systems the mapping Ψ must be defined for all actions and states because performing an action is always possible.

Let $\mathcal{L}$ be an action language for a $\mathbb{DS}4$ dynamic system. A **structure for** $\mathcal{L}$ is a pair $S = (\Psi, \sigma_0)$, where:

- Ψ is a transition function
- $\sigma_0 \in \Sigma$ is the initial state

A statement $s \in D_{trans}$ **is true in structure** S (in symbols $S \models s$) iff:

- s is of the form
$$\bar{f} \text{ after } A_1, \ldots, A_n$$
and $\Psi^\star((A_1, \ldots, A_n), \sigma_0) \models \bar{f}$
- s is of the form
$$A \text{ causes } \bar{f} \text{ if } g_1, \ldots, g_k$$
and for every $\sigma \in \Sigma$ such that $\sigma \models g_i$ for all i: $\Psi(A, \sigma) \models \bar{f}$

A structure $S = (\Psi, \sigma_0)$ is a **model** of action domain D in a language over the signature $\Upsilon = (\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{A}c)$ iff:

- $(\forall s \in D_{trans})\ S \models s$
- for every effect statement s of the form
$$A \text{ causes } \bar{f} \text{ if } g_1, \ldots, g_k$$
and for every $\sigma \in \Sigma$, if one of the following holds:
  - $s \in D_{trans}$ and $(\exists i \in \{1, \ldots, k\})\ \sigma \not\models g_i$
  - $s \notin D_{trans}$

  then $\sigma \models \bar{f}$ iff $\Psi(A, \sigma) \models \bar{f}$

Let $S = (\Psi, \sigma_0)$ be a model of D (determined using D_{trans} only). The **cost function** $Cost : \mathcal{A}c \times \Sigma \to \mathbb{N}$ is then uniquely determined by Ψ and D_{cost} as follows:

$$Cost(A, \sigma) = \begin{cases} \kappa & \text{if } (A \text{ costs } \kappa) \in D_{cost} \text{ and } \Psi(A, \sigma) \neq \sigma \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

The *otherwise* branch covers two cases mandated by assumption A5: (a) no cost statement for A appears in D_{cost}, and (b) A has an empty effect in state σ (i.e. $\Psi(A, \sigma) = \sigma$). In both cases $Cost(A, \sigma) = 0$.

Since $Cost$ is uniquely determined by Ψ and D_{cost}, we write the full structure as a triple $S = (\Psi, \sigma_0, Cost)$ as a notational convenience, understanding $Cost$ as a derived component.

A **program** P is a sequence of actions to be performed starting from the initial state. The cost of a program $P = (A_1, \ldots, A_k)$ is defined as:

$$Cost^\star((A_1, \ldots, A_k)) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} Cost(A_i,\ \Psi^\star((A_1, \ldots, A_{i-1}), \sigma_0))$$

where $\Psi^\star((), \sigma_0) = \sigma_0$ by convention.

3 Query Language statements

Q1: Goal satisfaction

$$\gamma \text{ after } P$$

Where γ is the goal condition (a set of literals) and P is a program.

Q2: Executability with Cost

$$P \text{ executable with cost } \kappa$$

Where $\kappa > 0$ and P is a program.

Q3: Executability with exact Cost

$$P \text{ executable with exact cost } \kappa$$

Where $\kappa > 0$ and P is a program.

4 Semantics of the query language

4.1 Partial Initial States

A partial initial state represents a set of complete states (completions), each assigning a truth value to every fluent while remaining consistent with the given literals.
Execution of a program P from a partial state σ_0 induces a set of possible models:

$$S_i = (\Psi^i, \sigma_0^i, Cost)$$

Q1: Goal satisfaction

A query of the form:

$$\gamma \text{ after } P$$

is a consequence of action domain D iff for every model $S_i = (\Psi^i, \sigma_0^i, Cost)$:

$$(\forall \bar{f} \in \gamma) \quad \Psi^i(P, \sigma_0^i) \models \bar{f}$$

Q2: Executability with Cost

A query of the form:

$$P \text{ executable with cost } \kappa$$

is a consequence of action domain D iff for every model $S_i = (\Psi^i, \sigma_0^i, Cost)$:

$$Cost(P, \sigma_0^i) \leq \kappa$$

Q3: Executability with exact Cost

A query of the form:

$$P \text{ executable with exact cost } \kappa$$

is a consequence of action domain D iff for every model $S_i = (\Psi^i, \sigma_0^i, Cost)$:

$$Cost(P, \sigma_0^i) = \kappa$$

Examples

Example 1

Let's consider the following statements:

$$\text{initially } \neg doorOpen$$

$$openDoor \text{ causes } doorOpen \text{ if } hasKey$$

$$openDoor \text{ costs } 5$$

Program

$$P = (openDoor)$$

Completions of σ_0

$$\sigma_0^1 = \{\neg doorOpen, hasKey\}$$
$$\sigma_0^2 = \{\neg doorOpen, \neg hasKey\}$$

Execution

Case 1: σ_0^1 Precondition holds, so:

$$\sigma_1^1 = \{doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Cost:

$$Cost^\star(P) = 5$$

Case 2: σ_0^2 Precondition does not hold, so:

$$\sigma_1^2 = \{\neg doorOpen, \neg hasKey\}$$

Cost:

$$Cost^\star(P) = 0$$

Final States

$$\{\sigma_1^1, \sigma_1^2\}$$

Query Results

Q1: Goal Satisfaction

$$\{doorOpen\} \text{ after } P$$

is false because *doorOpen* does not hold in all final states.

Q2 and Q3: Executability with Cost

$$P \text{ executable with exact cost } 5$$

is false since $Cost^{\star}(P)$ is not always 5.

$$P \text{ executable with cost } 5$$

is true since for all executions:

$$Cost^{\star}(P) \leq 5$$

$$P \text{ executable with cost } 0$$

is false since there exists an execution with cost 5.

Example 2

Let's consider the following statements:

$$\text{initially } \neg doorOpen$$

$$\text{initially } hasKey$$

$$openDoor \text{ causes } doorOpen \text{ if } hasKey$$

$$openDoor \text{ costs } 5$$

Program

$$P = (openDoor, openDoor)$$

Execution

Initial state:

$$\sigma_0 = \{\neg doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Action 1 Precondition holds, so:

$$\sigma_1 = \{doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Cost:

$$Cost(openDoor, \sigma_0) = 5$$

Action 2 Precondition holds, but no change occurs:

$$\sigma_2 = \{doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Cost:

$$Cost(openDoor, \sigma_1) = 0$$

Total Cost

$$Cost^{\star}(P) = 5$$

Query Results

Q2: Executability with Cost

$$P \text{ executable with cost } 5$$

is true.

Q3: Executability with exact Cost

$$P \text{ executable with exact cost } 10$$

is false since:

$$Cost^{\star}(P) = 5 \neq 10.$$

Example 3

Let's consider the following statements:

$$\text{initially } \neg doorOpen$$

$$doorOpen \text{ after } openDoor$$

$$openDoor \text{ causes } doorOpen \text{ if } hasKey$$

$$openDoor \text{ costs } 5$$

Program

$$P = (openDoor)$$

Completions of σ_0

$$\sigma_0^1 = \{\neg doorOpen, hasKey\}$$
$$\sigma_0^2 = \{\neg doorOpen, \neg hasKey\}$$

However, σ_0^2 is not consistent with the action domain.
Indeed, since $hasKey$ does not hold, the effect does not apply, and by inertia:

$$\Psi(openDoor, \sigma_0^2) \models \neg doorOpen$$

But the value statement requires:

$$\Psi(openDoor, \sigma_0^2) \models doorOpen$$

This is a contradiction. Therefore, σ_0^2 is not allowed.

Execution

Thus, the only possible initial state is:

$$\sigma_0 = \{\neg doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Precondition holds, so:

$$\sigma_1 = \{doorOpen, hasKey\}$$

Cost:

$$Cost^{\star}(P) = 5$$

Final States

$$\{\sigma_1\}$$

Query Results

Q1: Goal Satisfaction

$$\{doorOpen\} \text{ after } P$$

is true.

Q2: Executability with Cost

$$P \text{ executable with cost } 5$$

is true.

Q3: Executability with exact Cost

$$P \text{ executable with exact cost } 5$$

is true.

Example 4

Let's consider the following statements:

$$\text{initially } \neg doorOpen$$

$$\text{initially } \neg hasKey$$

$$doorOpen \text{ after } openDoor$$

$$openDoor \text{ causes } doorOpen \text{ if } hasKey$$

$$openDoor \text{ costs } 5$$

Program

$$P = (openDoor)$$

Execution

There is no model satisfying all statements, because:

- $\sigma_0 \models \neg hasKey$
- the effect requires $hasKey$
- the value statement enforces $doorOpen$ after $openDoor$

These constraints are inconsistent.

Query Results

All queries are undefined since no model exists.

4.2 Example 6: The Vault Room

Let's consider a scenario involving a vault room protected by wards and physical security layers and a thief that wants to access the vault illegally. He was given a key, but is not sure whether it is the key to the vault he plans to rob, and has no way to check it. Smashing the door is loud and it triggers the alarm and costs physical effort, but it always opens the door. Picking the lock is elegant and quiet, but it requires the key the thief has to be the right one for the lock to work and bypass the vault's wards, otherwise it completely fails.

4.2.1 Action Domain Statements

$$\text{initially } \neg doorUnlocked$$

$$\text{initially } \neg alarmActive$$

$$doorUnlocked \text{ after } pickLock, smashDoor$$

$$pickLock \text{ causes } doorUnlocked \text{ if } hasKey$$

$$smashDoor \text{ causes } doorUnlocked$$

$$smashDoor \text{ causes } alarmActive$$

$$pickLock \text{ costs } 2$$

$$smashDoor \text{ costs } 8$$

4.2.2 Program

$$P = (pickLock, smashDoor)$$

4.2.3 Completions of σ_0

Because the status of the fluent $hasKey$ is left unspecified by the initial historical assumptions, we must generate all possible complete initial states:

$$\sigma_0^1 = \{\neg doorUnlocked, \neg alarmActive, hasKey\}$$

$$\sigma_0^2 = \{\neg doorUnlocked, \neg alarmActive, \neg hasKey\}$$

However, σ_0^2 is not consistent with the value statement constraint in the action domain. Let us evaluate its branch:

1. **Action 1 ($pickLock$):** Since $hasKey$ does not hold in σ_0^2, the conditional effect does not apply. By the law of inertia, the state remains completely unchanged:

$$\Psi(pickLock, \sigma_0^2) \models \neg doorUnlocked$$

2. **Action 2 ($smashDoor$):** The execution continues to the final state:

$$\Psi^\star((pickLock, smashDoor), \sigma_0^2) \models doorUnlocked$$

But our structural rules dictate that a multi-step value statement f after $A_1, \ldots, A_n$ enforces satisfaction at *every* intermediary path step where that action prefix sequence resolves. The constraint $doorUnlocked$ after $pickLock, smashDoor$ demands that:

$$\Psi(pickLock, \sigma_0^2) \models doorUnlocked$$

This yields a direct contradiction with our step 1 transition evaluation. Therefore, the completion σ_0^2 is invalid and is completely filtered out of the model construction phase.

4.2.4 Execution

Thus, the only valid, consistent initial state structure is:

$$\sigma_0 = \{\neg doorUnlocked, \neg alarmActive, hasKey\}$$

Action 1: *pickLock* The precondition $hasKey$ holds true, meaning the postcondition triggers successfully:

$$\sigma_1 = \{doorUnlocked, \neg alarmActive, hasKey\}$$

Cost calculation: Since $\Psi(pickLock, \sigma_0) \neq \sigma_0$, the full cost statement maps:

$$Cost(pickLock, \sigma_0) = 2$$

Action 2: *smashDoor* Both effects of the smashing operation execute unconditionally:

$$\sigma_2 = \{doorUnlocked, alarmActive, hasKey\}$$

Cost calculation: While $doorUnlocked$ was already true and remains unchanged, the fluent $alarmActive$ transitions from false to true. Because a state transition occurred ($\Psi(smashDoor, \sigma_1) \neq \sigma_1$), the empty effect rule does not apply:

$$Cost(smashDoor, \sigma_1) = 8$$

Total Program Cost

$$Cost^\star(P) = 2 + 8 = 10$$

4.2.5 Final States

$$\{\sigma_2\}$$

4.2.6 Query Results

Q1: Goal Satisfaction

$$\{doorUnlocked, alarmActive\} \text{ after } pickLock, smashDoor$$

is true because both literals explicitly hold in the singular final state space model σ_2.

Q2: Executability with Cost

$$pickLock, smashDoor \text{ executable with cost } 10$$

is true since for all valid executions:

$$Cost^\star(P) \leq 10$$

Q3: Executability with exact Cost

$$pickLock, smashDoor \text{ executable with exact cost } 10$$

is true because the alternative inconsistent branch was eliminated, ensuring that $Cost^{\star}(P) = 10$ holds deterministically across all true models of the domain.